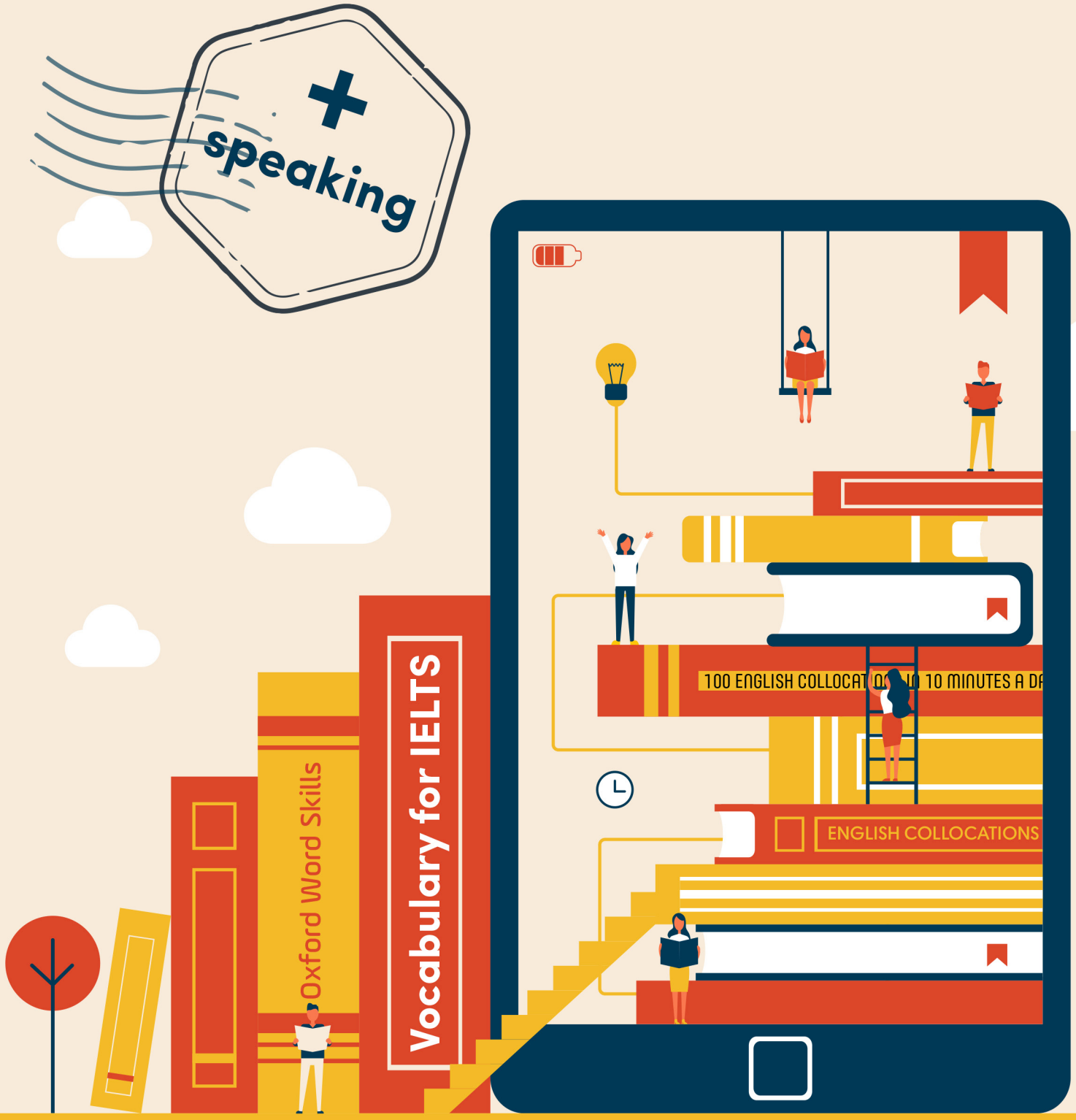
IELTS Up Words!

دوره لغات آیلتس

Yasaman Esmaeili

Yasi.esl



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Lesson 47: Society

Hi! I hope you are doing well! You are listening to lesson forty-seven of IELTS Up Words! In the previous lesson, we talked about communities, and in this lesson, we will take things one step further and talk about society.

But what is society?

Cambridge Dictionary defines society as "a large group of people who live together in an organized way, making decisions about how to do things and sharing the work that needs to be done. All the people in a country or several similar countries can be referred to as a society."

Living in society comes with its pros and cons. One of the downsides is the fact that you cannot be yourself. Instead, you have to blend in if you don't want to be considered an outcast or a rebel. Conservative members of society usually frown upon anything out of ordinary. They cannot accept those who try to redefine the norms and social mores. Although this attitude can help persevere the culture, it can negatively affect the harmony in society and divide people.

Now, let's go through a related question. By now, it must have gotten easier for you to speak and come up with ideas to talk about. Push harder with each question and make sure your response is better every time.

What is the biggest social problem in your country?

I would say there are numerous social issues here in my country, the biggest one being poverty, which is due to a constant rise in the cost of living today. More and more citizens are falling behind on their rent, mortgage, or cannot afford basic needs. Consequently, a larger segment of society is choosing to live in slums and other crime-infested or run-down areas. Honestly, I think poverty has turned into a global issue and all governments should take drastic measures if they want to eradicate it.

When answering an IELTS speaking or writing question, you don't need to tell the truth. Sometimes, your mind might go blank, so if you can't think of anything that actually happened and is worth talking about, make something up. Coming up with stories is not easy, though. It comes with practice, but after a while, you will get the hang of it.

Speaking Tip

Speculate but Don't Generalize!

Speculation and Hypothesizing

- In part three, they often ask you to speculate. For example, you might be asked to imagine a different scenario than the one you are in.
- You might also be asked to talk about the possibility of something happening in the future.
- The language below can help you show a degree of uncertainty when you speak.

Question: How will the jobs change in ten years?

Answer: I imagine they will be mostly tech-related, and probably done by robots.

Question: Do you think you will ever move to another country?

Answer: I expect/suppose so, yes. I will probably move to Canada in a few years.

Question: Do you think it is possible to live on other planets?

Answer: Although there are many hurdles in the way of making such progress, I think it is likely that humankind will find and live in a new home soon.

Avoid Generalization

The Deadly Sin: Avoid making generalizations in part 3 questions.

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
society	a group of people living as a community or an organized group of people for a common purpose	جامعه	social (adjective)
to blend in	to look or seem the same as surrounding people or things	همرنگ‌شدن؛ درهم‌آمیخته‌شدن	to fit in; to adapt
an outcast	a person who has been rejected by their society or social group	رانده؛ مطرود	
a rebel	a person who resists authority, control, or convention	یاغی؛ کسی که مخالف قوانین، سلطه، و سنت است	Rebellious to rebel
conservative	not usually liking or trusting change, especially sudden change	سنت‌گرا؛ محافظه‌کار	old-fashioned; conventional
to frown upon something	to disapprove of something	ناپسندشمردن؛ چیزی را نپسندیدن	to oppose something; to disfavor something opposite: approve; favor (verb)
redefine the norms	to change the way people think about social standards and norms	تعریف دوبارهٔ هنجارهای اجتماعی	reconsider; rethink
social mores	social norms that are widely observed within a particular society or culture	عرف جامعه؛ رسوم پذیرفته‌شده توسط جامعه	customs; conventions; traditions

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
to preserve the culture	to keep something as it is, especially in order to prevent it from decaying or being damaged or destroyed	محافظت کردن فرهنگ	
harmony	a situation in which people are peaceful and agree with each other	تناسب و توازن	
slums	a dirty and overcrowded area inhabited by very poor people	زاغه؛ محله‌های فقیرنشین	ghetto; skid row (informal)
a larger segment of society	a larger portion of the population	بخش بزرگ‌تری از جامعه	more and more people
crime-infested areas	areas with a high incidence of criminal activity	مناطق پرجرم‌وجنایت	crime-ridden
run-down areas	areas that are in a poor or neglected state after having been prosperous	مناطق مخروبه	shabby; broken-down
eradicate poverty	put an end to poverty	برچیدن فقـر؛ ازبین‌بردن فقر	eliminate; get rid of

other words/ structures	meaning	translation	other structures
to take things one step further	to add something more; to advance; to develop a point (in a discussion)	یک گام جلوتر رفتن	to go even further; to go the extra mile
pros and cons	advantages and disadvantages	جنبه‌های مثبت و منفی؛ نقاط قوت و ضعف	strengths and weaknesses
push harder	increase the amount of effort/energy to achieve something	بیشتر تلاش کن	put in more effort
to fall behind on your rent	to fail to pay your rent on time	عقب‌افتادن در پرداخت اجاره	
mortgage	money borrowed from a bank or other financial organization, especially to buy a house or other property	وام مسکن	mortgage loan ;home loan
a global issue	any issue that harmfully affects the global community and environment, such as environmental issues	مشکل/بحران جهانی	worldwide issue; universal problem
take drastic measures	take extreme actions to solve an undesirable situation	انجام اقدامات شدید	draconian measures
if your mind goes blank	if you suddenly forget or are unable to think of something	همه‌چیز را فراموش‌کردن؛ زمانی که چیزی به ذهن آدم نمی‌رسد	
to get the hang of something	to learn how to do something, especially when it is not simple or obvious	راه‌وچاه چیزی را یادگرفتن؛ قلق کاری یا چیزی را آموختن	to get the knack of something; to become skilled at
speculation	the activity of guessing possible answers to a question without having enough information to be certain	گمانه‌زنی؛ خیال‌پردازی	speculate
hypothesize	to give a possible but not yet proved explanation for something	فرض‌کردن؛ فرضیه‌پردازی	hypothesis



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